

WRITING THE RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Practical Tips, Do's and Don't, and Everything You Need to Know

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Writing the Results Section

What belongs in Results:

- Findings directly related to your research questions
- Data presented in logical order (often matching your methods/objectives order)
- Tables and figures that summarize data (with brief textual description)
- Statistical values (p-values, means, SD, correlation coefficients, etc.)

What does NOT belong in Results:

- Interpretation ("this suggests that...")
- Comparison with other studies
- Speculation on causes or implications
- Opinions or recommendations

Structuring the Results

1. Start with an overview sentence

RQ1: The study developed a Barangay Record Management System using the [SDLC model], following its prescribed development phases from requirements analysis through system implementation. Then proceed to the specific results per SDLC phase.

RQ2: The developed Barangay Record Management System was technically assessed by [N] IT experts to determine its performance based on the identified technical evaluation criteria. Then present the table of technical assessment results and discuss the overall pattern and notable findings, rather than repeating every value.

RQ3: The usability of the developed Barangay Record Management System was assessed by [N] end-users to determine their evaluation of the system based on the identified usability criteria. Then present the usability results and highlight the most notable patterns.

Structuring the Results

2. Present findings in the same order as your objectives

3. Use tables/figures for detailed numbers; use text to highlight key patterns — don't repeat every number in both

Example of Table in APA Format

Use label called 'Table' followed by Arabic numeral (Bold text)

Title in title case, left aligned, and italic

Use dividing lines

Center all headings

First column left aligned

Other columns centered

Year	Bachelor's Degrees	Master's Degrees	Doctor's Degrees
2014-15	9,771	6,582	3,065
2015-16	10,068	7,582	3,725
2016-17	10,187	7,756	3,893
2017-18	10,930	8,030	4,085
2018-19	11,084	8,349	4,125
2019-20	11,825	8,931	4,524

Note. table 300 in National Education Statistics; 2018 ed., United States Dept. of Education, Institution of Education Science, National Center for Education Statistics, June 2018, nces.ed.gov/programs/usde/d08/tables.asp.

Source of table called 'Note' in italics

Structuring the Results

4. Move from general findings to specific/detailed findings

*The technical assessment results showed that the developed system received a **favorable overall evaluation from the IT experts**. Among the evaluated technical criteria, **functional suitability obtained the highest overall rating**. At the indicator level, the system received its highest assessment for its **ability to provide the required barangay record management functions**, while **[specific indicator]** obtained the relatively lowest rating.*

5. End with a very brief summary statement (optional, no interpretation)

Practical Tips for Results

1. Report, Don't Repeat

DO: Mention only the important or notable findings from the table.

- *The system received favorable ratings across all technical criteria, with **security obtaining the highest rating**.*

DON'T: Repeat every number already shown in the table.

- *The system obtained 4.70 for functionality, 4.55 for performance efficiency, 4.60 for compatibility, 4.65 for reliability, and 4.72 for security.*

Rule: *The table contains the details; the text highlights what matters.*

Practical Tips for Results

2. Past Tense, Objective Voice

DO: Report what was found using objective, past-tense language.

- The system **obtained an overall mean of 4.62.**
- The end-users **rated the system highly in terms of ease of use.**

DON'T: Use present/future tense or subjective statements.

- The system **is getting** a high rating.
- I think the system **is very good and user-friendly.**

Rule: *Results describe what happened or what was observed—not what the researcher thinks.*

Practical Tips for Results

- **3. One Idea per Paragraph**

DO: Keep closely related findings together and give each paragraph a clear focus.

- The system obtained favorable ratings for functionality. The highest-rated indicator was record retrieval, indicating that respondents gave particular attention to the system's ability to locate stored records.

DON'T: Put unrelated findings into one long paragraph.

- The system obtained a high functionality rating. The interface was also easy to use. The database was tested using 500 records. The IT experts also evaluated security. The development team used Agile. The users liked the search function.

Rule: *One paragraph = one main finding or closely related group of findings.*

Practical Tips for Results

4. Let the Data Breathe

DO: Allow the table or figure to present the detailed data, then discuss the important pattern.

- **Table 2. Technical Assessment of the Developed System**
[Complete table with indicators, means, and interpretations]
- As shown in Table 2, the system received favorable ratings across all technical criteria. Security obtained the highest assessment, while performance efficiency received the relatively lowest.

DON'T: Put the entire table into paragraph form.

- As shown in Table 2, functionality had a mean of 4.70, performance efficiency had 4.55, compatibility had 4.60, reliability had 4.65, and security had 4.72...

Rule: *Don't make the reader read the same information twice.*

Practical Tips for Results

5. Label Everything

DO: Give every table and figure a number and descriptive title, then refer to it in the text.

- **Table 2. Technical Assessment of the Barangay Record Management System**
- As shown in **Table 2**, the system obtained favorable ratings across all evaluated criteria.

DON'T:

- The table below shows the results.
- Or:
- The results are presented below.

Rule: *Every table/figure should be identifiable and should be mentioned in the narrative.*

Practical Tips for Results

6. Be Precise with Numbers

DO: Use consistent decimal places, units, and scales.

- The system obtained an overall mean of **4.62 on a 5-point scale**.
- The average response time was **1.45 seconds**.

DON'T:

- The system obtained a mean of **4.6** in one table and **4.625** in another.
- The system responded in **1.45**.
- The second example is incomplete because the **unit (seconds)** is missing.

Rule: *Numbers should be consistent, meaningful, and accompanied by their appropriate units or scale.*

The developed Barangay Record Management System was technically assessed by **10 IT experts** using the identified software quality criteria. The assessment covered **functional suitability, performance efficiency, compatibility, reliability, security, maintainability, and portability.**

[Insert Table Here]

As shown in **Table 2**, the system received **favorable assessments across all evaluated technical criteria.** Among the assessed characteristics, **security obtained the highest overall rating,** while performance efficiency received the relatively lowest assessment.

At the indicator level, the highest-rated item under security concerned the system's **user authentication and access control,** whereas the relatively lower assessment under performance efficiency concerned **system response during record retrieval and report generation.**

To sum, the IT experts provided favorable assessments of the technical characteristics of the developed Barangay Record Management System.

Overview → General finding → Table/Figure → Important specific finding → Brief summary

Writing the Discussion Section

What belongs in Discussion:

- Interpretation of your key findings
- Comparison with previous studies (do they agree or disagree? why?)
- Explanation of unexpected results
- Theoretical or practical implications
- Limitations of the study
- Suggestions for future research

What does NOT belong in Discussion:

- New results not previously presented
- Excessive repetition of the Results section
- Overgeneralized claims not supported by your data
- Unrelated tangents about the broader field

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

1. Restate the Main Findings

DO: Briefly remind the reader of the major result without repeating statistics.

- The developed Barangay Record Management System demonstrated favorable technical quality and usability based on the assessments of IT experts and end-users.

DON'T:

- The system obtained a mean of 4.62 from IT experts and 4.58 from end-users, with security obtaining 4.72 and usability obtaining 4.65.
- The numbers already belong in the **Results** section.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

2. Interpret — What does this mean in context?

- Move beyond *what happened* to explain **what the finding means for the project**.

DO:

- The favorable technical assessment suggests that the developed system was able to address the identified functional and technical requirements of barangay record management. This indicates that the system provided an appropriate technological solution for organizing, retrieving, and managing barangay records.

DON'T:

- The system obtained a favorable rating.
- That's merely **reporting the result**, not interpreting it.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

3. Compare — Relate to Previous Literature

- Connect your finding to previous studies.

If your finding agrees:

- The favorable technical assessment was consistent with previous studies that reported positive evaluations of web-based record management systems. This agreement suggests that incorporating structured database management and role-based access features may contribute to the technical acceptability of similar systems.

If your finding disagrees:

- In contrast to previous studies that reported usability concerns among first-time users, the present study showed favorable usability assessments from the end-users. This difference may be attributed to the system's interface being designed around the actual record-management activities performed by the target users.

If your study extends previous literature:

- While previous studies primarily focused on digitizing barangay records, the present study extended this approach by integrating record management, search and retrieval, and report generation within a single system.

DON'T:

- This result is the same as the study of Santos (2024).
- That's too shallow. Explain **how** your result agrees, differs, or extends the literature.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

4. Explain — Why might the result have occurred?

- This is particularly useful when you have an **unexpected or relatively low-rated indicator**.

DO:

- The relatively lower assessment of the system's performance efficiency may be associated with the volume of records processed during testing and the available hardware and network conditions in the implementation environment.
- Or, for usability:
- The relatively lower usability assessment for some navigation-related indicators may be attributed to users' limited familiarity with computerized record management systems.

Notice the careful language: **“may be associated with,” “may be attributed to.”**

DON'T:

- The system was slow because the computers were old.
- Unless you actually collected evidence proving that, this is too definitive.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

5. Acknowledge Limitations

- A limitation should be honest without making the entire study sound invalid.

DO:

- The technical assessment was limited to the selected IT experts, while the usability assessment involved end-users from the intended implementation setting. Consequently, the findings may not fully represent the perceptions of users and technical evaluators from other barangays or local government contexts.
- Or:
- The evaluation focused primarily on technical quality and usability. Actual long-term effects on record-processing time and administrative efficiency were not measured.
- That second one is particularly important if you **didn't conduct an actual before-and-after efficiency study**.

DON'T:

- The study was limited because there were only a few respondents, so the results may not be reliable.
- That's unnecessarily self-defeating.

Better:

- Although the number of evaluators was limited to the selected participants, they were chosen based on their relevance to the technical and operational evaluation of the system.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

6. State Implications

- Now answer: “**So what?**”

Practical implication

- The findings indicate that the developed system may serve as a practical tool for supporting barangay personnel in managing, retrieving, and maintaining digital records.

Theoretical/academic implication

- The findings provide additional evidence that an SDLC-based development approach can be applied in developing information systems tailored to the operational requirements of local administrative offices.

Institutional implication

- The results may provide a basis for barangay administrators to consider the adoption of computerized record management practices as part of their efforts toward more organized digital information management.

DON'T overclaim:

- The system will completely eliminate errors and transform barangay governance.
- Your findings probably don't support such a broad conclusion.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

7. Recommend Future Directions

- Recommendations should **logically come from your limitations and findings**.

DO:

- Future studies may evaluate the system using a larger number of barangays and end-users to determine whether the findings remain consistent across different implementation contexts.
- Future research may also examine the system's long-term effects on record retrieval time, processing efficiency, and user productivity using pre-implementation and post-implementation measures.
- Further development may incorporate additional features such as automated notifications, data backup and recovery, mobile accessibility, and integration with other local government systems.

DON'T:

- Future researchers should conduct more studies about the system.
- Too vague. Tell them **what should be studied and why**.

Structuring the Discussion (Funnel Approach – Reverse of Introduction)

8. Strong Concluding Statement

- End the discussion by bringing the findings back to the **purpose of the study**.

DO:

- Overall, the findings indicate that the developed Barangay Record Management System provided a technically sound and usable solution for the identified record management requirements, while also demonstrating the potential of an SDLC-based approach for developing information systems responsive to local administrative needs.
- Or, a stronger and more concise version:
- Taken together, the findings demonstrate that the developed system provided a viable technology-based approach to addressing the identified needs of barangay record management.

The developed Barangay Record Management System demonstrated favorable technical quality based on the assessment of IT experts. This indicates that the system adequately addressed the identified technical and functional requirements of the intended record management environment.

The finding is consistent with Olipas (2024) on computerized local government record management systems, which similarly reported favorable technical evaluations of systems designed to organize and automate administrative records. The present study extends these findings by applying the development approach specifically to the operational requirements of barangay-level record management.

The favorable assessment may be attributed to the use of structured requirements analysis during system development, which allowed the major system functions to be aligned with the identified needs of the target users. However, the technical assessment was limited to the selected IT experts and therefore may not fully represent assessments from other technical environments.

The findings suggest that the system may be considered a practical technological solution for supporting barangay personnel in managing and retrieving records. Future studies may evaluate the system across multiple barangays and examine its long-term effects on processing time and administrative efficiency.

Taken together, the findings demonstrate that the developed system provided a technically viable approach to addressing the identified requirements of barangay record management.

Finding → Meaning → Literature → Reason → Limitation → Implication → Future Research → Strong Takeaway

“What happened?” → “So what?” → “Does literature agree?” → “Why?” → “What should we be careful about?” → “Why does it matter?” → “What next?”

Practical Tips for Discussion

1. Don't just summarize — synthesize

- **Connect your findings to the bigger picture.**

DO:

- The favorable usability assessment suggests that the system was generally suitable for its intended users. This indicates that the computerized approach may help support routine barangay record management activities.

DON'T:

- The system received a favorable usability assessment. The users gave high ratings to ease of use, learnability, and user satisfaction.

Rule: Don't simply repeat the Results. **Explain what the findings mean and why they matter.**

Practical Tips for Discussion

2. Use hedging language

- Be careful when making claims that are not directly proven by your data.

DO:

- The relatively lower assessment of performance efficiency **may be associated with** the processing requirements of record retrieval and report generation.

DO:

- The findings **suggest that** the system was generally easy to use.

DO:

- This result **could be attributed to** the users' familiarity with the existing record management procedures.

DON'T:

- The system received a lower performance rating **because the database is inefficient.**

DON'T:

- The system **definitely improves** barangay productivity.

Rule: Use words such as **may, might, could, suggests, indicates, appears to, is likely to, and possibly** when the evidence does not establish a definite cause or effect.

Practical Tips for Discussion

3. Address every objective

- Make sure nothing stated in the Introduction is left unanswered.

DO:

- The first objective focused on the development of the system, which was accomplished through the selected SDLC approach. The second objective assessed its technical characteristics through IT experts, while the third evaluated its usability among intended end-users. The findings addressed all three objectives of the study.

DON'T:

- The system was developed successfully and received favorable ratings from the respondents.
- **Why?**
The second version is too general and does not clearly show that **each objective/research question was addressed**.

Rule: Create a mental checklist:

Objective 1 → addressed. Objective 2 → addressed. Objective 3 → addressed.

Practical Tips for Discussion

4. Explain unexpected results

- Do not hide findings simply because they are different from what you expected.

DO:

- Contrary to the expected result, performance efficiency received the relatively lowest assessment among the technical criteria. This may be related to the processing requirements of functions involving record retrieval and report generation. However, this interpretation should be treated cautiously because the study did not directly measure the technical factors contributing to the lower assessment.

DON'T:

- Performance efficiency received the lowest rating.

DON'T:

- The low rating was caused by poor system performance.

Rule: When a result is unexpected, ask:

“What could explain this result?”

Then provide a reasonable explanation while acknowledging uncertainty.

Practical Tips for Discussion

5. Keep limitations honest but proportionate

- **Acknowledge limitations without making your entire study sound useless.**

DO:

- The usability assessment was conducted among the intended users of the system within the selected barangay. Therefore, the findings may not fully represent the experiences of users from other barangays with different workflows and technological environments.

DON'T:

- The study only involved one barangay, so the findings cannot be trusted and cannot be applied anywhere.

Rule: A limitation should define **the boundary of your findings**, not destroy the value of your research.

Practical Tips for Discussion

- **6. Avoid overclaiming**
- **One study rarely proves something definitively.**

DO:

- The findings suggest that the developed system can support the identified barangay record management activities.

DO:

- The results provide evidence that the system was favorably assessed by the participants involved in the study.

DON'T:

- The study proves that the system is the best solution for all barangays.

DON'T:

- The system will completely eliminate problems in barangay record management.

DON'T:

- This study proves that computerized record management is always better than manual record keeping.

Rule: Match the strength of your claim to the strength of your evidence.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

- One of the most common panel/adviser complaints is:
"Your Chapter 1 (Related Literature) and Chapter 3 (Results and Discussion) don't talk to each other."
- A strong Discussion doesn't just cite new sources at random — it **reaches back into your own literature review** and uses it as evidence, contrast, or explanation for your findings.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Why This Matters

- Your Related Literature/Studies chapter is not just a formality to satisfy a page-count requirement — it exists to build the **theoretical and empirical foundation** your Discussion will stand on. If none of those sources reappear in your Discussion, *Then why did you review them?*

A well-tied Discussion shows that:

- Your study is genuinely **situated within existing knowledge**, not isolated from it
- You understand **how your findings relate** to what others have already found
- You can **think critically**, not just report data

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Two Types of Literature — Use Them Differently

Most Discussion paragraphs benefit from combining both: a theory to explain the *mechanism*, and a study to show the *pattern is not unique to you*.

Type	Example	How to Use in Discussion
Theoretical/Conceptual literature	A theory, model, or framework (e.g., Technology Acceptance Model, Maslow's Hierarchy, ISO 25010 quality model)	Use to explain why something happened — the theory becomes your lens of interpretation
Empirical/Research literature	Prior studies with their own findings (e.g., "Reyes, 2021 found that...")	Use to compare your findings — do you agree, disagree, extend, or contradict?

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

The "Claim → Cite → Compare → Explain" (CCCE) Paragraph Structure

- A literature-tied Discussion paragraph almost always follows this internal logic:
 1. **Claim** — State your own finding in plain terms (no new citation yet)
 2. **Cite** — Bring in a source from your Related Literature chapter
 3. **Compare** — Explicitly say whether it agrees, disagrees, or extends your finding
 4. **Explain** — Offer the reason *why* they align or diverge
- **Example:** (*Claim*) The high mean rating for functional suitability suggests that the system meets its intended purpose effectively. (*Cite*) This supports the study of **Reyes (2021)**, who found that systems developed through a structured requirements-gathering process tend to score higher in functional accuracy. (*Compare*) Similar to Reyes's findings, the present study's system also underwent a rigorous needs-analysis phase prior to development. (*Explain*) This suggests that grounding system design in actual user-identified problems — rather than assumed requirements — is a key factor in achieving high functional suitability.
- Notice: the citation is not just dropped in — it's actively **used to explain** the result.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Techniques for Different Situations

When your finding *agrees* with prior literature:

- This finding is consistent with / supports / corroborates / affirms the work of (Author, Year), who similarly found that... Use this to build credibility — "I'm not the only one who found this."

When your finding *disagrees* with prior literature:

- This finding contradicts / differs from / diverges from the results of (Author, Year), who reported... This discrepancy may be explained by differences in [sample size / context / instrument / population / setting]. Never just say "the results are different" — always propose a reason.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Techniques for Different Situations

When your finding *extends* prior literature:

- While (Author, Year) established that ____, the present study extends this by showing that... in the context of _____. Useful when your study applies a known concept to a new setting (e.g., a new population, industry, or technology).

When using a theory/framework to explain a mechanism:

- This result can be explained through the lens of [Theory Name], which posits that... According to [Theory Name], this outcome would be expected because...

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Techniques for Different Situations

When literature helps explain an unexpected/anomalous result:

- This unexpected finding may be understood through (Author, Year)'s observation that... One possible explanation, drawing from the work of (Author, Year), is that...

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Common Mistakes When Tying Literature to Discussion

1. "Citation dumping" — naming several studies in one sentence without explaining how each relates to your finding.

-  *"This is similar to Reyes (2021), Cruz (2020), and Santos (2019)."*
-  *"This aligns with Reyes (2021), who attributed similar outcomes to structured requirements-gathering — a process also followed in this study."*

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Common Mistakes When Tying Literature to Discussion

2. Introducing brand-new sources never mentioned in Chapter 2 — if a source is important enough to interpret your results, it should have appeared (at least briefly) in your literature review. Introducing it for the first time in Discussion looks like an afterthought.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Common Mistakes When Tying Literature to Discussion

3. Citing without comparing — simply stating "(Author, Year) also studied this topic" without saying whether your results agree or disagree adds no analytical value.

4. Over-quoting — pulling long quotes from your literature sources instead of paraphrasing weakens your own voice and can raise copyright/originality concerns. Paraphrase, and cite only the source, not the exact wording.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Common Mistakes When Tying Literature to Discussion

5. One-way citation — using literature only to support findings that agree with you, while ignoring sources that would explain contradictory results. A strong Discussion isn't afraid to engage with sources that complicate the picture.

6. Treating theory as decoration — mentioning a theoretical framework in Chapter 1 but never actually applying it to interpret results in Chapter 3. If you introduced a theory, use it.

Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Practical Tip: Build a "Literature Map" Before Writing Discussion

- Before drafting, make a simple table linking each key finding to the literature that will help interpret it. This prevents last-minute scrambling for citations and ensures your Chapter 2 sources are actually used.

Your Finding	Related Literature (from Ch. 1)	Agree/Disagree/Explain	Planned Use in Discussion
High functional suitability (M = 4.60)	Reyes (2021) — structured requirements-gathering improves accuracy	Agree	Use to explain why the system scored high
Low portability (M = 3.90)	Domingo (2021) — desktop-only systems score lower in portability	Agree	Use to explain the limitation
High awareness but moderate implementation	(no direct match found)	—	Flag as a gap; may need to search for 1–2 additional sources before finalizing

Phrase Bank - Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Introducing a comparison:

- This finding is in agreement with the study of (Author, Year), who found that...
- Consistent with the results of (Author, Year), the present study also revealed...
- This corroborates earlier findings by (Author, Year) regarding...

Phrase Bank - Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Introducing a contrast:

- In contrast to (Author, Year), the current study found that...
- This finding diverges from that of (Author, Year), possibly due to...
- Unlike the results reported by (Author, Year), respondents in this study...

Phrase Bank - Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Explaining agreement or disagreement:

- This similarity may be attributed to the shared context of...
- This discrepancy could be explained by differences in [sample/setting/instrument]...
- The alignment between these findings suggests a broader pattern that transcends...

Phrase Bank - Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Applying a theoretical framework:

- This result can be interpreted through the lens of [Theory], which suggests that...
- Drawing from [Theory], this outcome may be understood as a function of...
- This supports the core premise of [Theory], namely that...

Phrase Bank - Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Extending prior literature:

- Building on the work of (Author, Year), this study demonstrates that the same pattern holds true in the context of...
- While previous research focused on ____, the present study extends this understanding to...

Phrase Bank - Tying the Reviewed Literature to the Discussion

Flagging a gap in the literature (when your finding doesn't match anything in Ch. 1):

- This finding does not appear to have been directly addressed in existing literature, suggesting an area for further investigation.
- Limited prior research has examined this specific relationship, making this an original contribution of the current study.

The Do's and Don'ts in Results and Discussion

Do	Why
Present results objectively before interpreting	Keeps reader trust; separates fact from opinion
Use consistent verb tense (past for results, present for accepted facts)	Improves clarity and professionalism
Refer to every table/figure in the text	Ensures nothing is "orphaned"
Compare your findings to existing literature	Shows scholarly awareness
Acknowledge limitations honestly	Builds credibility
Use hedging language for uncertain claims	Reflects appropriate scientific caution
Tie the discussion back to your research question	Keeps the paper focused
Use clear topic sentences for each paragraph	Improves readability

The Do's and Don'ts in Results and Discussion

Don't	Why It's a Problem
Mix interpretation into the Results section	Confuses fact with opinion
Repeat all raw data from tables in the text	Redundant and unreadable
Use vague statements like "results were good"	Not measurable or meaningful
Overstate the significance of findings	Misleads readers; not scientifically sound
Ignore or hide contradictory/negative results	Undermines credibility if discovered
Introduce new data in the Discussion	Confuses structure; should appear in Results
Use overly emotional or biased language	Reduces scientific objectivity
Write the Discussion as a copy of the Results	Fails to add analytical value
Claim causation from correlational data	Statistically and logically incorrect

Common Mistakes to Avoid

1. Blending Results and Discussion

Problem: Interpreting the data before the reader has seen the actual finding.

DON'T:

- The system obtained a mean of 4.62, which indicates that the system was highly effective because its features were designed according to the needs of the barangay staff.
- The sentence immediately jumps from the number to an explanation.

DO:

- The system obtained an overall mean score of 4.62 for the technical assessment. The result indicates that the system received a favorable technical assessment across the evaluated criteria.
- Then, in the **Discussion**:
- The favorable technical assessment suggests that the system adequately addressed the identified technical requirements. This may be attributed to the alignment between the system's functions and the requirements identified during development.

Simple rule:

Results = What did you find?

Discussion = What does the finding mean?

Common Mistakes to Avoid

2. "Data Dumping"

Problem: Listing every statistic without telling the reader what is important.

DON'T:

- Functionality obtained a mean of 4.71, performance efficiency obtained 4.55, compatibility obtained 4.63, reliability obtained 4.68, security obtained 4.75, maintainability obtained 4.59, and portability obtained 4.61.
- The reader sees numbers but does not know the important pattern.

DO:

- The system received favorable assessments across all technical criteria. **Security obtained the highest assessment**, while **performance efficiency received the relatively lowest rating**.
- The detailed numbers can remain in the table.

Simple rule:

Table = detailed data.

Narrative = important patterns.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

3. Weak Topic Sentences

Problem: Starting with the table instead of the finding.

DON'T:

- Table 3 shows the usability assessment of the system.
- This tells the reader what the table contains, but not what was found.

DO:

- **The developed system received a favorable usability assessment from the intended end-users.**
- Then introduce the table:
- Table 3 presents the detailed usability assessment across the evaluated indicators.

Simple rule:

Start with **the finding**, not **the table**.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

4. Ignoring Negative or Null Results

Problem: Students sometimes discuss only favorable findings because they think negative results make their research look bad.

Suppose the system was expected to receive a high rating for all usability indicators, but **interface organization received a neutral assessment**.

DON'T:

- The system was highly usable and received favorable assessments from the end-users.
- This hides an important result.

DO:

- Although the system received favorable assessments overall, **interface organization obtained a relatively lower assessment** than the other usability indicators. This suggests that certain aspects of the interface may still require refinement.
- Then discuss why:
- The relatively lower assessment may be related to the arrangement or presentation of interface elements. However, the study did not specifically examine which interface components contributed to this assessment.

Simple rule:

A negative or null result is **still a result**. Discuss it honestly.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

5. Overgeneralizing

Problem: Making claims that go far beyond the participants or setting of the study.

Suppose the study involved **30 end-users from one barangay**.

DON'T:

- The study proves that the Barangay Record Management System is effective for all barangays in the Philippines.
- The sample cannot support that claim.

DO:

- The findings indicate that the developed system was favorably assessed by the end-users involved in the selected barangay. The findings may provide a basis for considering similar systems in other barangays, subject to differences in local procedures and requirements.

Simple rule:

Small/specific sample → appropriately specific conclusion.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

6. Excessive Hedging or Excessive Certainty

There are **two extremes** to avoid.

Too certain:

- **DON'T:**
- The system definitely improved the productivity of all barangay employees.
- The study may not have actually measured productivity.

Too cautious:

- **DON'T:**
- The system might possibly perhaps have some potential to maybe improve record management.
- This sounds uncertain and weak.

Balanced:

- **DO:**
- The findings suggest that the system **can support** routine barangay record management activities by facilitating record encoding, retrieval, and document processing.
- This is confident enough but still evidence-based.

Simple rule:

-  **Too certain:** “proves,” “definitely,” “always,” “will completely”
 **Too cautious:** “might possibly perhaps”
 **Balanced:** “suggests,” “indicates,” “may,” “can support,” “is consistent with”

Common Mistakes to Avoid

7. Not Connecting Back to the Research Question

Problem: The Discussion becomes a general essay about the software instead of answering the actual research question.

Suppose RQ2 asks:

- **What is the technical assessment of the developed system by IT experts?**

DON'T:

- Information systems are increasingly important in modern government. Barangays handle many types of records, and digital transformation has become an important part of public administration.
- These statements may be true, but they don't answer RQ2.

DO:

- The technical assessment showed that the developed system was favorably evaluated across the identified software quality criteria. This finding indicates that the system addressed the technical requirements established for the project.

Simple rule: At the end of each RQ discussion, ask:

- **“Did this paragraph help answer my research question?”**

Common Mistakes to Avoid

8. Comparing Without Explaining Differences

Problem: Students cite literature but fail to explain what the comparison means.

DON'T:

- The findings are consistent with Smith (2020), who also found that users gave favorable usability assessments.
- That's only a comparison.

DO:

- The favorable usability assessment is consistent with Smith (2020), who similarly reported positive user evaluations of computerized record management systems. The similarity may be attributed to the use of interfaces designed around users' existing administrative workflows. However, the present study focused specifically on barangay-level record management, extending the application of these findings to a local government context.
- Now the student explains:
- **What is similar**
- **Why it might be similar**
- **What the present study adds**
- **Simple rule:**
- Don't stop at:
- **“Our study agrees with Smith.”**
- Continue with:
- **“Why do they agree, and what does our study add?”**

Common Mistakes to Avoid

9. Weak Limitations Section

There are also **two extremes**.

Extreme 1: No limitation

DON'T:

- The study successfully developed and evaluated the system.
- Nothing tells the reader about the boundaries of the findings.

Extreme 2: Excessive apology

DON'T:

- The study was conducted only in one barangay and involved only a small number of participants. Therefore, the results are very limited and may not be reliable or useful.
- This unnecessarily discredits the study.

Balanced approach:

DO:

- The study was conducted within a selected barangay and involved participants who represented the intended users of the system. Consequently, the findings may not fully represent the experiences of users from barangays with different administrative procedures or technological environments. Nevertheless, the findings provide relevant evidence regarding the system's technical and usability characteristics within the context examined.

Simple rule:

A limitation should establish **scope**, not **self-destruction**.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

10. Poor Paragraph Organization

Problem: Jumping from one topic to another without a logical sequence.

DON'T:

- The system received a high usability rating. The database was developed using MySQL. Security also received a high rating. Previous studies have reported similar findings. The system uses role-based access. The users found the interface easy to use. Future researchers should study mobile applications.
- Everything may be relevant to the study, but the paragraph has **no clear flow**.

DO:

- The system received a favorable usability assessment from the intended end-users. The highest assessment was observed in ease of use, suggesting that users were generally able to perform the system's primary functions without difficulty. This finding is consistent with previous studies emphasizing the importance of user-centered design in information systems. The favorable assessment may be related to the alignment of the system's functions with the users' existing record management activities. However, some interface elements received relatively lower assessments, indicating areas that may be refined in future versions.

Notice the flow:

- **Finding → Meaning → Literature → Explanation → Limitation/qualification → Implication**

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

A. Introducing Results

- The results indicate/show/reveal that...
- As shown in Table 1/Figure 2...
- A significant difference was observed between...
- There was a notable increase/decrease in...
- The data suggest a trend toward...
- No significant difference was found between...
- Overall, the findings demonstrate...

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

B. Describing Trends and Patterns

- increased/decreased steadily
- remained relatively constant
- fluctuated across...
- was consistently higher/lower than
- showed a marked improvement in
- peaked at / reached its lowest point at

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

C. Reporting Statistics

- was statistically significant ($p < 0.05$)
- did not reach statistical significance
- was strongly/moderately/weakly correlated with
- accounted for X% of the variance
- yielded a mean of ... (SD = ...)

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

D. Introducing the Discussion

- These findings suggest that...
- This result is consistent with / contradicts previous research by...
- One possible explanation for this finding is...
- Taken together, these results imply...
- This may be attributed to...
- An unexpected finding was that...

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

E. Comparing with Other Studies

- This finding aligns with the work of (Author, Year), who reported...
- In contrast to (Author, Year), the current study found...
- Similar patterns have been observed in previous studies (e.g., Author, Year)
- This supports the hypothesis proposed by...
- Unlike earlier studies, this research found...

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

F. Hedging Language (Expressing Appropriate Caution)

- may suggest / could indicate / appears to
- it is possible that...
- these results might be explained by...
- this finding tentatively supports...
- further research is needed to confirm...

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

G. Acknowledging Limitations

- One limitation of this study is...
- These findings should be interpreted with caution due to...
- The small sample size may limit the generalizability of...
- Future studies should address this limitation by...

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

H. Stating Implications

- These findings have important implications for...
- This study contributes to the growing body of literature on...
- Practically, these results suggest that...
- From a theoretical standpoint, this supports...

Phrase Bank – Useful words and expressions

I. Concluding the Discussion

- In summary, these findings demonstrate...
- Overall, the current study provides evidence that...
- Future research should explore...
- Further investigation is warranted to determine...

Labeled Elements of a Figure in APA Format

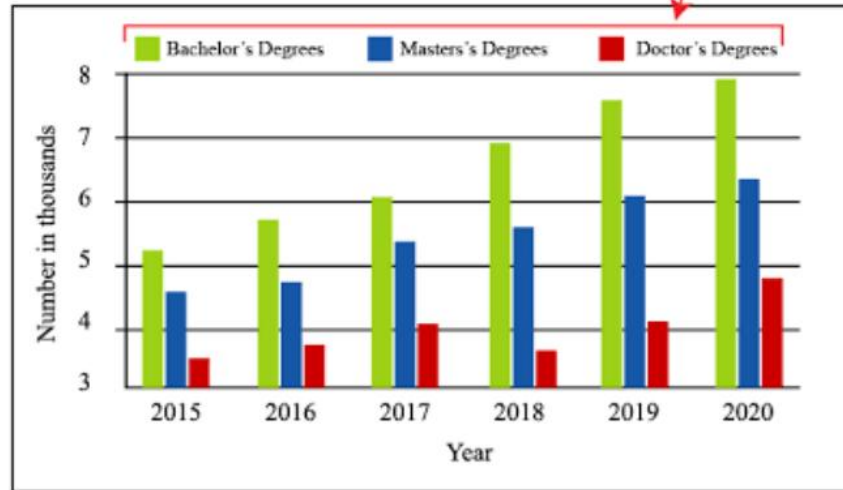
Figure number (bold text)

Figure 1

Degrees in Modern Art in United States

Figure title (italic text)

Legend: Explanation of symbols or colors used in image.



Note. Bachelor's Degrees, Master's Degrees, and Doctor's Degrees earned in a 5 year span.

'Note' in italic text followed by a period with a description of the figure.

Example of Table in APA Format

Use label called 'Table' followed by Arabic numeral (Bold text)

Table 1

Degrees in Modern Art in United States

Title in title case, left aligned, and italic

Use dividing lines

Center all headings

First column left aligned

Other columns centered

Year	Bachelor's Degrees	Master's Degrees	Doctor's Degrees
2014-15	9,771	6,582	3,065
2015-16	10,068	7,582	3,725
2016-17	10,187	7,756	3,893
2017-18	10,930	8,030	4,085
2018-19	11,084	8,349	4,125
2019-20	11,825	8,931	4,524

Note. table 300 in National Education Statistics; 2018 ed., United States Dept. of Education, Institution of Education Science, National Center for Education Statistics, June 2018, nces.ed.gov/programs/usde/d08/tables.asp.

Source of table called 'Note' in italics

WRITING THE RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

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Presented by:
Dr. Cris Norman P. Olipas